

User generated design label

ModClothing launches user generated design clothing collection mostly selected and voted from its Facebook community



No Carla for Nokia?

Is Nokia cancelling out updates for symbian or using different terminologies for their updates?
<http://dgit.in/KdCZCG>

Bazaar

Nikon 1 V1

Appeasing that need for speed (and accuracy)

The V1 is Nikon's top-end player in the mirrorless camera segment. It employs magnesium-alloy as the choice of contraction material, lending it a very solid feel. The camera feels sturdy to hold, yet doesn't feel overtly heavy. The base of the camera is made of high-grade plastic that does not feel flimsy in the slightest.

A proprietary 10 megapixel sensor with hybrid-contrast-phase detect delivers stunning image quality and handles high ISO's rather well. The noise looks more like film grain and often lends an elegant feel to the image. The focus system is one of the best we've seen so far in a mirrorless camera, with the ability to acquire and track subjects rather quickly. Did we mention it performs just as well under low levels of lighting?

The camera also boasts of dual shutters (mechanical and electronic) that can be conveniently switched at will to compensate for the shortcomings of one another. While the mechanical shutter gives the more traditional experience, the electronic shutter (in Hi mode) enables the shooting of an insane 60 frames per second. Now before you go ahead and claim blasphemy, let us elaborate. The electronic shutter does shoot 60 frames per second (34 RAW frames till buffer is full), however, the focus AND the exposure is locked for the first frame, allowing the mode to be only used when the subject and the camera are not moving (or moving so perfectly that their relative motion is equal to zero. Physics nerds UNITE!)

After spending a considerable time with the V1, it seemed like Nikon had focused all its energies on developing a capable sensor and in the process, made some ridiculous design blunders. Firstly, we were taken aback to see that the PASM modes were not accessible through the mode dial. These modes can only be changed through the clunky and cluttered menu system. Secondly, where there should have been an on-camera flash, we found a proprietary port. Nikon wants you to shell out extra dough just to be able to shoot in low light. Oh, and the existing Speedlights from Nikon are not compatible (maybe an adapter will appear sometime in the future, but we wouldn't hold our breath).

The Nikon 1 system is in its nascent stages. The proprietary sensor means that you can only attack Nikon's 1-system-compatible lenses to the V1. The four lenses available for the Nikon 1 system are the 10-30mm F3.5-5.6 VR, the 30-110mm F2.8-5.6 VR, the 10mm F2.8 pancake and the (comparatively) enormous 10-100mm F4.5-5.6 VR power-zoom. Given the V1's 2.7x conversion factor, we find the wide end to be severely lacking. Not to mention the lack of fast primes is a little disappointing. However, the icing on the cake is the fact that none of the lenses have a built in manual-focusing ring.

Shooting with the V1 feels like you're using a very well built point-and-shoot. For a camera that is supposed to serve as a DSLR replacement, the V1 lets us down in its severe lack of (or rather inconvenient) manual controls. However, the



additional electronic viewfinder with its 1440K dot resolution is definitely a delight to look through, making us wish that other manufacturers would implement the same in their mirrorless cameras. An eye-sensor next to the viewfinder also helps switch automatically from the 920K LCD display to the viewfinder when the camera reaches eye-level.

The Nikon V1 is priced at a whopping ₹45,450 with a 10mm-30mm lens, which is a somewhat regular price range for a mirrorless camera. However, other manufacturers offer a lot more for the price, especially if you're investing in one of the four-thirds mount system like the Olympus PEN E-P3, which has a far better selection of lenses and definitely feels a lot SLR-like to use. However, if your primary concern is getting the best focusing system, a sensor that resembles the quality of a bigger four-thirds sensor up to ISO 3200 and can shoot 5 frames per second with auto-focus and exposure correction, then the Nikon V1 might be your only option.

Swapnil Mathur

Specifications

Sensor: Proprietary CX-format (1-inch) sensor;
Resolution: 10 Megapixel;
Lens Mount: Proprietary;
ISO range: 100-6400; **Focus system:** Hybrid Contrast-phase detection; Burst Mode: 60/30/5 frames per second

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Features	6.0
Performance.....	6.0
Build Quality	6.0
Value for Money	5.0